Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A J 7 4

♠ J 10 6 5 3
♥ 10 8 3
♦ 5
♣ Q 10 8 2

♠ Q 4
♥ Q J 9 6
♦ K Q 10 9 7
♣ K 6

♠ 8 7 2
♥ 7 5 4
♦ J 6 4 2
♣ 9 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			

2NT by North
Lead: ♦K

NORTH has a perfect hand for an opening bid of 2♣. 23 points and balanced distribution is just fine.

SOUTH is glad to hear his partner has lots of points, because he was shortchanged. However, he must answer, so with 1 point he bids a negative 2♦.

NORTH describes her hand by saying 2NT. SOUTH does not have to bid the double negative over a 2NT bid, so he passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q J 4 ♥ 9 4 3 ♦ 5 2 ♣ A J 8 6 3	
♠ K 7 3 ♥ Q 8 2 ♦ 10 9 8 6 ♣ 5 4 2		♠ A 8 2 ♥ A K 7 5 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q 10
	♠ 10 9 6 5 ♥ J 10 6 ♦ A 7 4 3 ♣ 9 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♦3

EAST has a balanced hand with 22 points. He opens 2♣.

WEST, with 5 points, must respond ♦. Both these bids are artificial.

EAST now describes his hand by bidding 2NT. WEST bids 3NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 27 points.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q J 10 7 2 ♥ A 5 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ 6 5 3	
♠ 9 4 ♥ 9 3 ♦ 6 5 3 ♣ Q J 9 8 7 2	N W E S	♠ A 8 6 5 ♥ 10 8 7 6 4 ♦ K J 10 ♣ 10
	♠ K 3 ♥ K Q J 2 ♦ A Q 9 8 ♣ A K 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 22 points.

NORTH has 8 points AND a 5-card ♠ suit. This is strong enough for a positive response, so he bids 2♠.

SOUTH completes the description of her hand by saying 2NT.

NORTH does NOT rebid the ♠s; his first bid already promised a 5-card suit. He just bids 3NT.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 8 7 4 ♥ J 4 ♦ Q 10 5 ♣ K J 5 3	
♠ K Q 2 ♥ A K Q 7 5 ♦ A 7 2 ♣ A 10		♠ A 3 ♥ 10 9 8 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 8 7 6 4
	♠ J 10 6 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ K J 4 3 ♣ Q 9 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♠7

WEST has 23 points and opens 2♣.

EAST, with 4 points, must respond 2♦.

WEST now shows a ♥ suit (at least 5) by bidding 2♥.

EAST likes ♥s, she has already told WEST she has fewer than 8 points, so she bids 4♥.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 8 7 ♥ A K ♦ A 8 6 ♣ A K Q J	
♠ 10 9 3 ♥ Q 8 4 2 ♦ K J 10 9 ♣ 8 2		♠ K 5 4 ♥ J 10 6 ♦ 7 4 3 ♣ 10 7 6 4
	♠ Q 6 2 ♥ 9 7 5 3 ♦ Q 5 2 ♣ 9 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥J

NORTH has lots of points - 26 to be exact. She opens 2♣. In the old days this hand would have been opened 3NT.

SOUTH has 4 points and responds 2♦.

NORTH now shows her full strength by jumping to 3NT (25-27 points, balanced).

SOUTH knows there is no slam, so he passes 3NT.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K J
♥ J 10
♦ A Q 9 4
♣ J 10 9 7 2

♠ 6 4 2
♥ 7 5 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ 8 6 5 3

♠ A 7 3
♥ A K Q 8 6 2
♦ 8 6
♣ A K

♠ Q 10 9 8 5
♥ 9 3
♦ K 10 5 3
♣ Q 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	
All Pass			

3♥ by East
Lead: ♠10

EAST has 22 points and opens 2♣.

WEST is pretty weak, right? She responds 2♦.

EAST bids his suit, 2♥.

WEST is so weak she bids the second negative - 3♣.

EAST rebids his suit, 3♥, and WEST passes.

Board 7
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 6 3
♥ A K 8 2
♦ K Q J
♣ K Q

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 10 4
♦ 9 6 4 3
♣ 8 6 4

♠ Q 9 5
♥ 6 3
♦ 10 8 7
♣ A J 10 9 2

♠ 4 2
♥ Q J 9 7 5
♦ A 5 2
♣ 7 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

NORTH has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, SOUTH can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥suit.

NORTH likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH bids 6♥.

Board 8
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 6 5 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q J 10 7 5 ♣ J 3 2	
♠ A J 9 8 3 ♥ K 7 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A 8 7 4	N W E S	♠ K Q 10 2 ♥ A Q J 10 5 ♦ A K 2 ♣ K
	♠ 7 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ 9 8 4 3 ♣ Q 10 9 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
7♠			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by West
Lead: ♥3

EAST opens 2♣ and is pleased when WEST makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that WEST will pass.

WEST now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. EAST continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for WEST to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.

Board 9
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A J 10 7 2 ♥ 9 8 7 ♦ 8 2 ♣ Q 5 3	
♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 5 3 ♦ 10 7 6 5 3 ♣ K 10 2		♠ 4 3 ♥ Q 6 4 ♦ J 9 4 ♣ A J 9 7 4
	♠ K Q 8 6 ♥ A K J 2 ♦ A K Q ♣ 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣A

SOUTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

NORTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give NORTH an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

NORTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which SOUTH passes.

Board 10
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 4 2 ♥ 10 9 4 3 ♦ Q J 2 ♣ K Q 10 2	
♠ A Q 9 ♥ A K 2 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ A J 7 4	N W E S	♠ K 6 3 ♥ Q 8 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ 9 5 3
	♠ J 10 8 7 5 ♥ J 7 6 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♠7

WEST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But EAST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

WEST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and EAST passes.

Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 5 4
♥ 9 6 4 3
♦ Q J 9
♣ J 7 6

♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q 10 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4

♠ 10 8 3
♥ K
♦ K 10 8 5 4 3
♣ Q 10 2

♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠4

SOUTH opens 2♣ and NORTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

SOUTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead. SOUTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So SOUTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and NORTH bids 4♥.

Board 12
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 8 7 ♥ 4 3 ♦ Q J 10 9 5 ♣ 9 6	
♠ Q 6 3 ♥ Q 8 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ K J 3	N W E S	♠ A K 9 ♥ A K 2 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ A Q 7 4
	♠ 5 4 2 ♥ J 10 9 7 6 ♦ 2 ♣ 10 8 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♥4

WEST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to EAST's 2♣ opening bid.

EAST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

WEST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K Q 8 6
♥ A K 10 8 2
♦ A
♣ 8 6

♠ 10 4 3
♥ Q 6
♦ K 9 6
♣ A K 7 5 2

♠ J 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ J 10 8 5 3
♣ J 10 4

♠ 7 2
♥ 9 7 5 3
♦ Q 7 4 2
♣ Q 9 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦J

NORTH has both Majors and enough points to open 2♣. SOUTH, with 4 points, responds with a negative 2♦.

NORTH first bids her higher ranking suit, 2♠. SOUTH is too strong for second negative, he bids 2NT.

NORTH now shows her second suit, 3♥.

SOUTH is happy to bid the game in ♥s.

Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 8 6
♥ J 7 6 4
♦ 4 3
♣ 6 4 3

♠ K 7 3
♥ 9 8 2
♦ A Q J 8 6
♣ J 2

♠ A Q 2
♥ A K Q 5
♦ K 7 5
♣ K Q 10

♠ 10 5 4
♥ 10 3
♦ 10 9 2
♣ A 9 8 7 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♠5

EAST has a balanced hand with 23 points. He opens 2♣ and expects to rebid 2NT.

WEST has 12 points so makes a positive response in her best suit. Since that suit is ♦s she must jump to the 3-level.

EAST now describes his balanced, minimum hand by bidding 3NT.

WEST bids 6NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 34 points.

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 10 9 7 2 ♥ 9 7 5 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ A 3	
♠ 4 3 ♥ 4 3 ♦ A 9 6 4 3 ♣ 9 7 6 2		♠ Q J 8 5 ♥ 10 8 6 ♦ 10 7 ♣ 10 8 5 4
	♠ K 6 ♥ A K Q J 2 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦A

NORTH, with 9 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH bids her ♥s and NORTH agrees the trump suit with a 4♥ bid.

SOUTH thinks there is a slam, so she invokes Blackwood. Hearing that NORTH holds two Aces she bids 6NT. She could also have bid 6♥ but 6NT scores a little more.

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 8 7 5 ♥ Q J 10 4 ♦ Q 5 4 ♣ 10 8 5	
♠ A K Q 10 3 ♥ A K 6 ♦ 8 6 ♣ A Q 4	N W E S	♠ J 4 2 ♥ 8 7 5 2 ♦ J 7 2 ♣ K 6 3
	♠ 9 6 ♥ 9 3 ♦ A K 10 9 3 ♣ J 9 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥Q

EAST has 5 points, so she responds 2♦ to WEST's opening 2♣ bid.

WEST bids his 5-card ♠ suit.

EAST is too good for the second negative, so she supports WEST's ♠.

WEST doesn't have enough to think about slam, so he signs off at 4♠.

Board 17
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ A 7 5 ♦ J 4 2 ♣ 6 5 3	
♠ 10 8 5 4 3 ♥ 10 8 3 ♦ K 10 ♣ 10 9 2	N W E S	♠ 9 6 ♥ 9 6 4 ♦ 7 6 5 3 ♣ Q J 8 7
	♠ A Q ♥ K Q J 2 ♦ A Q 9 8 ♣ A K 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

NORTH has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

SOUTH figures NORTH for 8 points and bids 6NT. If NORTH has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

Board 18
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 9 6 5 ♥ 10 9 7 4 ♦ Q 5 3 ♣ Q 3	
♠ K Q J 8 2 ♥ A 5 ♦ A K 2 ♣ A K 2		♠ 7 ♥ K Q J 8 3 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 8 7 4
	♠ 10 4 3 ♥ 6 ♦ J 10 7 4 ♣ J 10 9 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST opens 2♣ and EAST, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

WEST should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And EAST can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for WEST to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.

Board 19
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 8 7 ♥ A K Q 2 ♦ A K J 6 ♣ 6	
♠ 3 ♥ J 10 6 3 ♦ 9 8 4 ♣ J 10 8 4 2	N W E S	♠ 9 6 4 2 ♥ 9 7 4 ♦ 10 5 3 ♣ A 9 7
	♠ A J 10 5 ♥ 8 5 ♦ Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣J

After NORTH's 2♣ opening, SOUTH bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. SOUTH actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

NORTH's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking SOUTH for a 4-card Major. SOUTH mentions his ♠s and NORTH bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now SOUTH adds his 12 points to NORTH's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 9 8 7 ♥ 7 3 ♦ Q 5 4 ♣ K Q 9 4	
♠ A K Q 6 3 ♥ A K 10 9 6 ♦ 10 6 ♣ A	N W E S	♠ 2 ♥ Q J 5 2 ♦ 9 8 7 2 ♣ 10 7 6 3
	♠ J 5 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ A K J 3 ♣ J 8 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♥3

EAST has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to WEST's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when WEST bids 2♠.

However, when WEST then bids ♥s, EAST finds two more points and bids 4♥.

Board 21
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K J 2 ♥ Q 7 5 ♦ Q 10 7 2 ♣ 7 5 3	
♠ A 9 6 ♥ J 10 9 4 ♦ 9 ♣ 10 8 6 4 2	N W E S	♠ 7 4 3 ♥ 8 3 2 ♦ J 6 5 4 3 ♣ A 9
	♠ Q 10 8 5 ♥ A K 6 ♦ A K 8 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠4

SOUTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But NORTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so SOUTH must adapt. She shows her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since SOUTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 10 3 ♥ 10 7 6 3 ♦ 5 4 ♣ J 10 9 8 3	
♠ K 9 8 7 ♥ Q J 8 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 7 4		♠ A Q J 2 ♥ A K 5 ♦ K Q 7 3 ♣ A 6
	♠ 6 5 4 ♥ 9 4 ♦ A J 10 2 ♣ K Q 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♠4

EAST has a balanced 23-point hand. He opens 2♣.

With 6 points and two 4-card Majors, WEST can only say 2♦.

EAST shows his minimum hand with a 2NT rebid.

Now WEST bids 3♣. This is not the second negative, but rather it is Stayman.

When EAST shows his ♠ suit WEST bids 4♠.

Board 23
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8
♥ K Q 4
♦ A K Q J 8 6
♣ K 4

♠ 9 6 5 4 3
♥ 10 6 3
♦ 3
♣ Q 8 6 2

♠ Q J 10
♥ J 8 2
♦ 9 5 4
♣ J 10 9 7

♠ K 7 2
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ 10 7 2
♣ A 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by South
Lead: ♥6

NORTH opens 2♣.

SOUTH should just respond 2NT, even with 11 points. The idea is to make a positive response (which forces the partnership to game level), and show extra strength later.

This time there is no need. NORTH should bid 4♣ (Gerber), and SOUTH answers 4♠ for two Aces.

Next NORTH should ask for Kings, and when SOUTH shows one King NORTH should bid 7NT.

Board 24
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 10 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 4 ♣ 10 8 7 6	
♠ 9 7 3 ♥ 6 2 ♦ Q J 9 8 6 3 ♣ A 4		♠ 8 ♥ A K Q 5 ♦ A K 7 2 ♣ K Q J 3
	♠ J 6 5 4 ♥ J 10 9 8 3 ♦ 5 ♣ 9 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	6♦	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♦ by West
Lead: ♠K

When EAST opens 2♣ WEST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But, because her suit is ♦s, she must jump to 3♦.

EAST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that WEST holds one Ace.

That's all WEST needs to know to bid 6♦.